

Nielsen Norman Group **Heuristic Evaluation Workbook**

Use this workbook to conduct your own heuristic evaluation.

For each of Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics, look for specific places where the interface fails to adhere to the guideline. Write your recommendations for how to fix those usability issues.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

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PRODUCT: MedCare

TASK: HomePage Evaluation

1

Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its state?
- Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?

Issues

When browsing products or switching categories (Shop, Vitamins, Pain relievers) there's no clear loading feedback.

• Map/location loading status is unclear..

Recommendations

Add loading indicators when switching categories or loading maps.

Show status messages like "Searching nearby pharmacies."

2

Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design?
- Do the design's controls follow real-world conventions?

Issues

Some category labels (abbreviations like "Anti", "Vita") are unclear.

• Medical product grouping may not match how users usually search (by symptoms).

Recommendations

Use complete and familiar category names ("Antibiotics", "Vitamins").

Add categories like "For Fever", "For Cough", etc.

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3

User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action?
- Is *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

Issues

Users may not easily remove items from cart or undo actions.

Navigation between map and product screens is not always smooth.

Recommendations

Add clear "Remove from Cart" and "Undo" options.

Provide easy navigation back to previous screens.

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

Product cards and UI components vary slightly in layout.

Icons and buttons are not always uniform across screens.

Recommendations

Standardize product card design (same size, font, buttons).

Use consistent icons and button styles.

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5

Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues

No visible warnings when adding duplicate items to cart.

Location/map errors (no internet) are not handled clearly.

Recommendations

Show alerts like "Item already in cart."

Add error handling for map/location issues.

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues

Users must remember product categories or previous searches.

No search suggestions or filters visible.

Recommendations

Add search bar with auto-suggestions.

Include filters (price, category, availability).

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7

Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

No quick actions (reorder previous items).

No shortcuts for frequent users.

Recommendations

Add “Recently Bought” or “Favorites”.

Enable quick reorder feature.

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

Issues

Product screens look crowded with many items.

Some components feel repetitive.

Recommendations

Improve spacing and grouping of items.

Highlight important products or promotions only.

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9

Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

Issues

No clear error messages for failed searches or unavailable items.

Map errors (no GPS) are not explained.

Recommendations

Show clear messages like "No results found."

Suggest actions ("Check internet connection").

10

Help and Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues

No visible help for using map or shopping features.

No guidance for first-time users.

Recommendations

Add tooltips ("Tap to view pharmacy details").

Include a short tutorial or onboarding.